

Academic Works Guidelines

Universidade Europeia & IADE Libraries

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Introduction

The present document aims to serve as a guideline for the preparation of academic and scientific works and papers produced at the University. Although some adaptations may be made according to the nature of each course.

Although **APA - American Psychological Association** is the standard adopted at the Universidade Europeia, the **Portuguese standard style (NP-405)** is frequently used by law students.

This guide contains the directives present in the 7th edition of the American Psychological Association Handbook (APA, 2020).

The document is divided into three fundamental parts: structure of the academic work, text formatting, and main forms of citation and bibliographic references.

1. Structure of an academic work

1.1 Pre-textual elements

1.1.1 Cover page

The cover page is the identification of the work, and should contain all the elements that allow identifying the work:

Identification of the Institution (name and logo);

Course;

Title;

Name of the author (or authors);

Date (month and year).

1.1.2 Erratum

In long works, such as theses and dissertations, it is natural that, despite all the revision work, mistakes may appear. When these mistakes are detected after the documents have been submitted, an erratum should be prepared and added to the work.

An erratum is a list of the pages and lines where errors occur and their corrections.

The erratum should be presented on a separate sheet, which will be placed between the cover and the title page.

Mistakes may be, for example, punctuation marks, spelling mistakes, inverted commas (") that are placed at the beginning of the sentence and not placed at the end of the sentence, agreement mistakes (singular and plural), sentences that have missing words or too many words, among other aspects.

In this erratum example, 4 columns are presented:

1. The first column shows the page where the mistake appears;
2. In the second column is the line in which the mistake appears;
3. In the third column the sentence is transcribed as it appears in the document;
4. The fourth and last column presents the correct information.

Example:

Erratum

Page	Line	Where it reads	Should read
Abstract	13	(Solomon e Kotler, 2010)	(Solomon & Kotler, 2010)
Table of contents	15	Interpretation and discussion of results	Presentation and discussion of results
Table of contents	23	Banco da Portugal	Banco de Portugal
3	10	According to this concept the best (4) form of diagnosis	(4) According to this concept the best form of diagnosis
11	23	motor learning	Appropriate motor and cognitive learning
14	2	sinplified	simplified
25	12	Outdoor the the chair	Outdoor chair
63	1	5. Conclusions	3. Conclusions

1.1.3 Cover page

The cover page should have the same elements as the covers page, and it is the first page of the work. It has more informations and is not numbered. It **includes**:

Title of the work;

Subtitle (if there is any);

Name of the author (or authors);

Type of work;

Name of the Institution;

Name of the course (or subject or curricular unit);

Name of the Supervisor, lecturer, etc. (if applicable);

Place;

Date (year).

1.1.4 Acknowledgements

After the title page, there may be a page containing acknowledgements to people who have contributed, somehow, to the work.

1.1.5 Abstract and Keywords

The abstract should present briefly and in a few words the content of the work. It is important to indicate the methodology used, the target audience (if any), the results, discussion and conclusions.

The keywords are words or expressions that translate the main subjects of the work. They should be between 3 to 6.

Short note:

- Elements such as acknowledgements, abstract and keywords are present in works such as theses and dissertations. However, these elements are not necessary in simpler academic works;
- In the case of theses and dissertations, the abstract and keywords should be in english, or in the language in which the work is written; and in portuguese > Abstract / Keywords; Resumo / Palavras-chave;
- The format, position and presentation of these elements is in the theses and dissertations template.

1.1.6 Table of contents

The table of contents is a guide to the structure and contents of the work. It should mention all chapters and subchapters, in the order in which they appear throughout the text, indicating the page number on which each one begins.

Whenever possible, build the table of contents automatically, as this makes updating easier and minimises errors.

1.1.7 Other tables of contents

There are other table of contents that can be added to the work. For example, table of figures, charts, tables, graphs, annexes.

1.1.8 List of abbreviations

If abbreviations or acronyms are used, they must be listed and written out in full. This list allows the author to use the acronyms freely throughout the text. Note that, whenever an acronym is used for the first time in the text, it must be described in full as well.

1.2 Textual elements

1.2.1 Introduction

The introduction is the presentation of the work. It should contain all the elements that, in a concise way, explain to the reader what will be found in the development of the work. In general, the introduction should include the following topics:

- **Context of the research work/report;**
- **General topic;**
- **Problem;**
- **Specific goals;**
- **General answer to the problem;**
- **Structure of the research work/report.**

1.2.2 Methodology

This chapter describes in detail how the study was conducted. A rigorous, clear and detailed description is given of the methods and techniques used throughout the research process, from the exploratory phase of the research to the construction of data collection instruments (Ampudia de Haro et al., 2020).

The information present in this chapter is relevant as it allows checking whether the methods used were adequate, as well as the validation of the results (Ampudia de Haro et al., 2020).

The structure may follow the topics below, seeking to answer the questions "What?", "How?", "Where?", "With what?":

What?	Objectives/hypotheses: description of the problem and the objectives/propositions/hypotheses for its resolution.
	Definition of the object of study: present, describe and define the target or object of the study (individuals, groups, organisations, countries,...).
Where?	Sample: definition of the target of the study; the use of samples (sample size, sample construction,...) - if applicable.
How?	Method: description and justification of the methodological design used, including the type of study to be conducted (case study, survey, experimental research) and its approach (quantitative, qualitative, descriptive or explanatory).
With what?	Research techniques: detailed description of the research techniques applied, the procedures used, including what refers to the research instruments (interview, questionnaire, documentary analysis,...).

Table 1 – Questions to be answered in the methodology

1.2.3 Body text

The body text is the development of the work, and is considered the most relevant part of the work because it is where all the topics are addressed. This part of the text should be organized in chapters and subchapters, if applicable, in order to facilitate the reading and understanding of the subjects.

Along the development of the work, other elements can be added, such as tables, graphs, images, and others, which should be numbered according to the APA style.

The body text also includes the literature review, which is a presentation, synthesis and critical evaluation of the theory and studies on the subject of the work. Its development should allow to sustain, from a theoretical point of view, the research intended to be carried out.

A good literature review should include:

- **Key theories within the subject;**
- **Demonstrate up-to-date knowledge on the selected subject;**
- **Demonstrate how the research project relates to previously published research;**
- **Evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of the published studies;**
- **Support the research;**
- **Enable readers to consult the original studies, through citations and bibliographic references.**

1.2.4 Results analysis and discussion

It presents the description and interpretation of the collected data. These results should be guided by the objectives/hypotheses previously defined. Quantitative data must be presented in the form of tables or graphs that summarise the main results. In the case of qualitative data, it must be clear which analysis procedure was followed.

1.2.5 Conclusions

The conclusion should be used to present the main ideas or considerations emerging from the evidence and initial arguments. Conclusions should not be a surprise. They should confirm, or not, the hypotheses/objectives and provide suggestions or recommendations for solving the problem that is the origin of the research and the consequent development of the work.

Generally speaking, any conclusion should contain the following information:

- Summary of the traced objectives, and the main key ideas that form the answer;
- For the hypotheses formulation, the results that confirm the defined hypotheses should be presented;

- The relevance of the conclusions for the development of knowledge or the solving of the problem;
- Inherent limitations to the development of the study;
- Future paths of research; or practices suggested by the results achieved.

To include	To avoid
• Summarise and conclude, stating the key argument; • Present key conclusions and recommendations; • Describe if the initial questions have been answered; • Describe how the conclusions apply to practice; • Present the implications for future research; • Present the limitations of the work developed.	• New topics or new data; • Repeat the introduction; • Obvious statements; • Contradiction of ideas previously presented.

Table 2 – Aspects to consider in the conclusion

1.3 Post-textual elements

1.3.1 Bibliographic references

The list of bibliographical references provides the sources cited by the author to write the work.

Only the works/publications cited throughout the work should be listed.

If it is relevant to include other works that have not been cited in the text, it can be done so, but under another title, such as **recommended bibliography** (ESSLEI-IPL, 2018).

The list of bibliographic references is presented in alphabetical order.

1.3.2 Appendices

The purpose of an appendix is to add important but non-priority information.

According to Bowden (2004), appendices allow:

- **To complement the information that is in the body text;**
- **To detail the information without breaking the reasoning;**

- To inform readers who like to get more detail;
- To strengthen the topics described;
- To provide evidence to support the arguments;
- To present details of experiments or research;
- To provide documentary evidences.

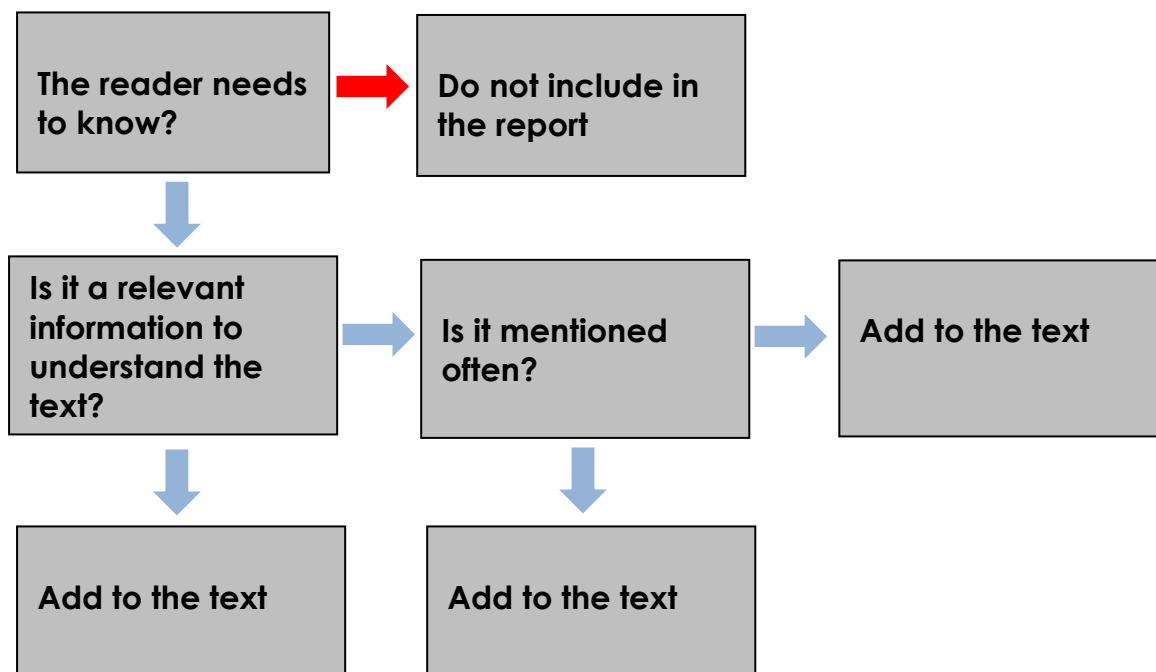


Table 3 – Appendix selection

1.3.3 Glossary

The glossary is a list of words related to the subject. It is optional. It should be placed at the end of the paper after the annexes. The words should be listed in alphabetical order.

2. Format

The format of the documents shall be uniform regarding margins, font and line spacing. The division between chapters, sections and paragraphs must also be standardised.

Please use A4 format paper printed on both sides of the paper.

Regarding the font, we suggest "Times New Roman", or another "with serif", and "without serif".

For the body text size, use 12pt with one and a half spaces between lines. The following margins must be respected:

- Top margin 2,5 cm;
- Bottom margin 2,5 cm;
- Left margin 2,5 cm;
- Right margin 2,5 cm.

Page numbering should be centered at the bottom of the page. The distinction between the several subdivisions of the work must be made on a numerical basis, except for the "parts" and "chapters", which will have an alphanumerical designation.

Note: This format is a guideline. For more details please check the templates available in the Canvas platform.

3. Works credited in the text

3.1 In-text citation

Citations are ideas and theories from other authors' works and serve to validate and reinforce what is intended to be demonstrated throughout the work. Each citation must identify the author in order to avoid plagiarism.

There are direct quotations (verbatim - transcriptions) and indirect quotations (paraphrases).

Below are the general guidelines for each type of citation throughout the text, illustrated with examples.

APA uses the author-date citation system.

Cite	First in-text citation	Subsequent citations
One author	According to Sarmento (2003) (Sarmento, 2003).	According to Sarmento (2003) (Sarmento, 2003).
Two authors	According to Nobre e Reis (2002) (Nobre & Reis, 2002).	According to Nobre e Reis (2002) (Nobre & Reis, 2002).
Three or more authors	According to Sarmento et al. (2014) (Sarmento et al., 2014).	According to Sarmento et al. (2014) (Sarmento et al., 2014).
Group author with abbreviation	According to Instituto Nacional de Estatística (INE, 2014) (Instituto Nacional de Estatística [INE], 2014).	Segundo o INE (2014) (INE, 2014).
Group author without abbreviation	Universidade Europeia (2019) (Universidade Europeia, 2019)	Universidade Europeia (2019) (Universidade Europeia, 2019)

Table 4 – Basic In-Text Citation Styles

3.1.1 Direct quotation

A **direct quotation** reproduces the exact words of another author. These quotations must:

- Be displayed between quotation marks;
- Include the surname of the author(s), the year of publication and also the number of the page(s) from which the quotation was taken.

Parenthetical citation (Author surname, year, page)	Mindfulness has a range of meanings as it "...has become a trend word conveying a diversity of understandings dependent on context" (Crane, 2017, p. 586).
Narrative citation Author appears in running text	As mentioned by Crane (2017, p. 586) "Mindfulness has become a trend word conveying a diversity of understandings dependent on context".

Table 5 – Direct quotation | Examples

3.1.2 Paraphrases

A paraphrase restates the author's words in a new way. Although following the idea of the author, the information is rewritten in new words, or summarizes the author's idea.

(Author surname, year)	Art therapy was found to be a useful tool to help a young boy with autismo relate to others (Emery, 2004).
Author appears in running text	Emery's (2004) case study of a boy with autism found art therapy to be a useful tool to help him relate to others.

Table 6 – Paraphrases | Examples

Note: Long quotations (paraphrase with several sentences or longer than 40 words) follow particular guidelines. Please check APA manuals or go to your library.

3.1.3 Quotations that contain citations to other works

This kind of quotation should be used only when it is not possible to access the original text.

Quoting material that contains embedded citations	Regarding loyalty "Aaker (1996b) understands that there are two orders of reasons why it should be part of the concept" (Mendes, 2014, p. 61). According to Stanislavski (1950), actors "are encouraged to become immersed in a character's life" (cited by Panero et al., 2016, p. 234). Actors "are encouraged to become immersed in a character's life (Stanislavski, 1950), an activity that calls for absorption" (Panero et al., 2016, p. 234).
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Table 7 – Quote of a quote | Examples

Note: In the bibliographic references list is displayed only the reference of the used material. In the examples above the books written by Mendes and by Panero are those that will be in the list.

3.2 Bibliographic references

The information sources used throughout the work are presented according to the APA standards and they appear in two moments: throughout the text (quotation) and in the reference list (at the end of the document). The quotations throughout the text are included in the reference list and vice-versa.

Only the authors or sources quoted throughout the work are listed.

3.2.1 Some details about the reference list

- Continue the arabic numbering of the pages;
- Start the 1st line of each reference close to the left margin of the page;
- Arrange the list in alphabetical order of the first author's surname;
- When there are several works by the same author, they are listed according to the date of publication, starting with the oldest and ending with the most recent, repeating the author's name in each publication.

Example | APA, 7th ed.:

Sontag, S. (1979). *On photography*. Penguin Books.

Sontag, S. (2012). *Ensaio sobre fotografia*. Quetzal.

Sontag, S. (2015). *Olhando o sofrimento dos outros*. Quetzal.

- When several works by the same author published in the same year have been used, these are presented in alphabetical order of title, adding a lowercase letter to the year to prevent confusion, and using the same methodology when quoting in the text.

Example | APA: (Alves, 1984a), (Alves, 1984b)

4. Other issues to consider when writing your work

When writing an academic work, the language used should be clear, coherent and appropriate.

Special attention should be paid to grammar, the use of verb tenses and pronouns as well as the active and passive voice.

For further information about these topics, please, check APA manuals or contact your library.

The following guidelines should also be observed:

Jargon and irony	Avoid jargon; Avoid irony and disregard for authors.
Transparency	Write the text so that it can be understood by the audience to which it is addressed (and consider that the reader is unaware of the topic).
Overview	Say as much as possible in the fewest words needed; Avoid long sentences, making paragraphs frequently.
Correction	Writing without spelling and grammatical mistakes; Use punctuation properly (avoid ellipsis and exclamation marks).
Coherency	Respect the use of verb tenses.
Order	Put the sentences, paragraphs and chapters into a logical and harmonious order.
Loyalty	Respect the study object and the sources consulted.
Originality	Avoid using set phrases; Present new ideas.
Accuracy	Avoid using ambiguous terms; Use terms and concepts by explaining them when they are first used.

An work should demonstrate coherent, critical and fluent reasoning on the subject addressed.

When it is being concluded, the text should be carefully revised in order to eliminate mistakes (if mistakes are found later, an erratum should be attached). To ensure a thorough revision, the work should be finalised a few days before the due date.

5. Bibliographic references

American Psychological Association (2020). *Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association* (7th ed.). <https://doi.org/10.1037/0000165-000>

Ampudia de Haro, F., Serafim, J., Faria, L., Roque, M. I., Ramos, M., Carvalho, P., & Costa, P. (2018). *Investigação em ciências sociais: Guia prático do estudante*. Pactor.

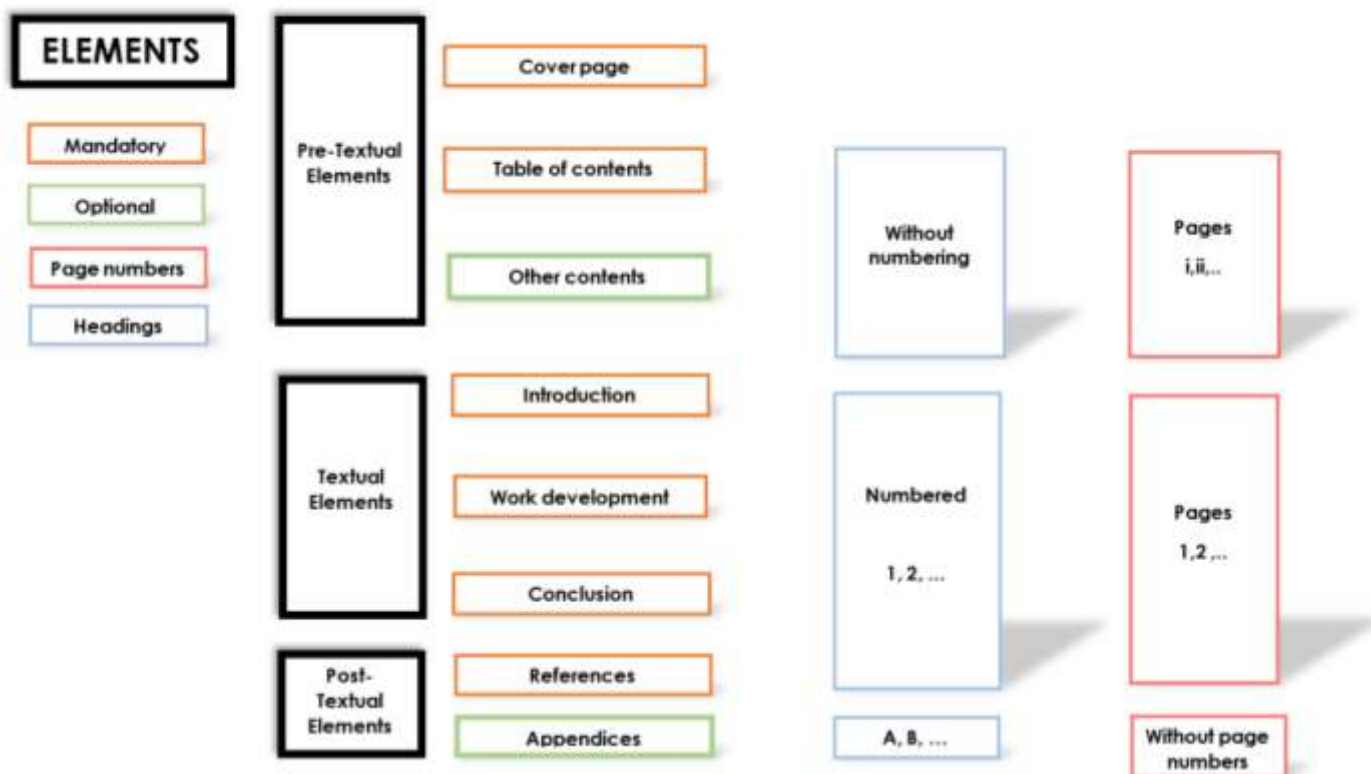
Bowden, J. (2004). *Writing a report: how to prepare, write and present effective reports* (8th ed.). How To Books.

Conselho Técnico-Científico ESSLEI-IPLEIRIA (2018). *Guia de elaboração de trabalhos académicos*.

<https://www.ipleiria.pt/esslei/wpcontent/uploads/sites/28/2015/03/Guia-de-elabora%C3%A7%C3%A3o-de-trabalhos-acad%C3%A9micos-ESSLei-2018.pdf>

Appendices

ACADEMIC WORK ELEMENTS AND FORMAT



THESES AND DISSERTATIONS ELEMENTS AND FORMAT

